

Break Down a Business Scenario into Copilot Components

Objective

This task goes beyond building a bot—it's about designing a resilient, modular system that understands user intent and drives real action. You'll translate a real-world workflow into Copilot-ready logic using trigger phrases, structured topics, and fallback strategies. Can your agent adapt to uncertainty, handle edge cases, and stay aligned with business logic? This is your chance to prototype a smarter, more human-centered automation.

Scenario

Imagine you're building a Copilot agent to handle vacation request processing for your company. Employees want to check leave balances, submit time-off requests, and understand approval timelines—all through natural conversation. Your task is to analyze this workflow and break it down into Copilot Studio's building blocks: trigger phrases, topics, actions, and generative fallbacks.

Instructions for learners

Using the provided scenario, complete the following steps

Define the Triggers

Write 5–7 natural-language phrases users might say to begin this interaction.

Examples: “Request vacation,” “How many days off do I have left?”

Outline the Topics

→ Break the interaction into 2–3 reusable topics (e.g., checking balances, submitting a request, canceling a leave).

→ For each topic, sketch the logic flow:

→ What questions should the bot ask?

→ What conditions or branches exist?

→ Should it call a Power Automate flow or update a system?

Add Generative Fallbacks

- Consider one open-ended question a user might ask outside of your topics.
- Example: “Can I take half-days on Fridays in August?”
- Write a generative fallback response strategy. Will the bot use knowledge sources? Escalate to a human?

Document the Flow

- Create a simple outline or diagram showing:
- Triggers → Topics → Actions/Responses
- Where generative answers step in
- Any tool integrations (e.g., SharePoint, HRIS)

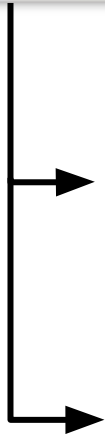
Checklist for Success

- Triggers are diverse, clear, and realistic
- Topics are logically grouped and modular
- Generative response has a thoughtful fallback plan
- Overall flow is complete and Copilot-ready

Bonus: Identify reusable topics that could apply to other HR processes

Submission

What to Submit



A short write-up or diagram outlining your trigger → topic → response map

A brief explanation (2–3 sentences) of how you ensured modularity and fallback resilience

Conclusion

Once you've drafted your Copilot structure, head into the Coach activity to reflect on how well your model anticipates user behavior, handles ambiguity, and supports reuse across business workflows.